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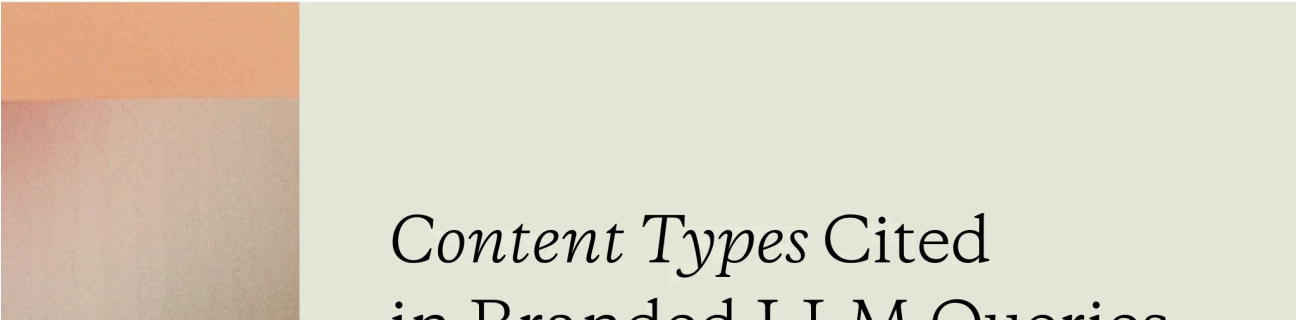
AI SEARCH

CONTENT STRATEGY

RESEARCH

Which Content Types LLMs Cite Most: 23,000+ AI Citations Analyzed [Research]

By Cate Dombrowski | January 20, 2026 | 10 min read



Content Types Cited

in Prompted LLM Queries



WHICH BRANDS AND INFORMATION GET LEFT OUT.

That's why share of voice in LLM search is becoming a competitive metric. If your brand isn't mentioned, you're missing the moment when customers are forming opinions and making decisions.

Organic growth has always been about showing up when someone needs an answer, and making sure what they find reflects the narrative you want associated with your brand. To do that in AI search, brands need to know which content types are most successful at earning citations.

Which content types do LLMs actually cite when people search for information about specific brands?

And more importantly: which content types are worth investing in?

How I analyzed LLM citations for

1 1 1 .



- B2B SaaS
- Consumer Products
- Professional Services
- Finance

Six user intent types

- Competitor Comparison: *"Which is a better CRM for mid-sized SaaS teams: HubSpot or Salesforce?"*
- Customer Reviews: *"What do customers say about Hoka? Are reviews generally positive or negative?"*
- Direct Evaluation: *"Is Chase a good choice for small business banking?"*
- Functionality / Integrations: *"Does Rare Beauty makeup include liquid blush products?"*



- Directory sites, brand profiles, documentation and support pages such as software integrations and how the product or service works
3. Education and Thought Leadership: *Owned and earned content meant to teach, persuade, and build authority.*
- Blogs, how-to guides, research, trends and stats roundups
4. News and Press: *Brand updates for public record.*
- Funding announcements, leadership changes, software updates, and press releases
5. Product Pages and Commercial Intent: *Pages that drive purchase decisions and remove friction.*



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the most for branded queries?

LLMs overwhelmingly lean on reviews and social proof



Reference sites

This 17% includes directories like Wikipedia and Product Hunt, and documentation and support like software integrations and how the product or service works.

A major part of this group is brand profiles: pages that contain must-have brand information summarized for the reader, hosted on a third-party website. Competitors and partners may do this to grab traffic when someone searches for your brand over theirs, like a competitor's page all about Omniscient.

Product pages and commercial content come in third

Product pages and commercial intent content make up 12% of citations.

It surprises me that when a user is explicitly asking about a brand like Nike and Adidas, there aren't more product pages, e-commerce links, or pricing



- Establish authority
- Building audience trust
- Create differentiation
- Drive discovery

But for branded queries specifically, it doesn't show up very often.

Why? Branded queries are closer to purchase intent. When a user already has a brand in mind, they're not asking "teach me", they're asking "validate this decision."

Thought leadership may be more relevant to category discovery and early-stage learning.

Brand foundation pages don't stand out in LLM



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Sense— if you have content in the exact form users are searching for, why wouldn't the LLM cite that exact page? But in this data, that wasn't the case.

They aren't major drivers of LLM outputs for the same reason as thought leadership: users (and the models) need specific product/service details and comparisons to answer branded queries.

Video and press citations are the lowest

Video content (like YouTube) and news/press releases show up the least in branded queries.

While the overall citation rate for video is low in our dataset, video can be a high leverage opportunity to showcase your product and build social proof. Happy customers and evangelists who create positive product review videos can be cited as well as referenced directly to improve your trust and credibility. Additionally, video is often a lower competition channel, so it is often easier to see results quickly from video efforts.



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Here's what's happening underneath the data:



What you can control on your brand website:

- Listicles
- Product and Service Pages
- Pricing Pages
- Blogs and Articles
- Case Studies
- Documentation / support
- Video

What you can control through outreach:

- Listicles
- Brand Profiles



Your content strategy should include all four rungs of this ladder.

1. LLM Magnets (highest visibility)

If the main goal is AI visibility in branded queries, start managing reviews, listicles, brand profiles, and comparison pieces.

These capture the highest intent information users are asking for:

- Competitor comparisons



3. Authority builders (indirect but essential)

These may not show up often directly in branded queries, but they influence how LLMs understand your brand overall.

Authority lifts your ability to win citations with content from the top two tiers because models, search engines, and people learn you're reputable enough to recommend.

4. Table stakes (necessary, but not the visibility driver)

Brand foundations aren't cited often, but they're still required for SEO, user trust, and clarity once someone clicks through.

How to make your brand more visible in LLM answers



5. Use authority content to lift everything else.

Thought leadership might not be the top cited source in branded queries, but it still shapes how models perceive your credibility.



AI Search Strategy

What We
Learned
from
Building
Our Reddit
Engagement
Program

Content Strategy

AI Citation
Briefs: A
Repeatable
Workflow
for Your
SME
Content
Strategy

AI Search Research

How I
Created the
Perfect
Prompt Set
for AI
Visibility
Research



Omniscient Digital is an organic growth agency that helps B2B software businesses turn SEO, GEO, and content into growth channels.

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- Best SaaS SEO Agencies
- Best B2B SEO Agencies
- Best Generative Engine Optimization (GEO) Agencies
- Best B2B Content Marketing Agencies
- Best SaaS Content Marketing Agencies
- Best Marketing Agencies

Content Guides

- Product-Led Content
- Content Marketing Strategy
- Barbell Content Strategy
- Decentralized Content Marketing
- Content Economics



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